

Internal Audit Procedure

Purpose

This procedure defines the process for planning, conducting, reporting, and closing internal quality audits at Acme Corporation.

Scope

This procedure applies to all internal audits of the Quality Management System, production processes, and supplier quality systems.

Definitions

Internal Audit: A systematic, independent examination of processes and records to determine conformity to requirements.

Auditor: A qualified person who performs the audit. Must be independent of the area being audited.

Audit Finding: Evidence of conformity or non-conformity identified during an audit.

Procedure

Step 1: Audit Planning

The QA Manager develops the annual audit schedule by December 15 for the following year. Each process area must be audited at least once per year. High-risk processes are audited twice per year.

The audit schedule considers:

- Previous audit results
- Process risk and complexity
- Changes to processes or personnel
- Customer complaints or quality trends
- Regulatory requirements

Step 2: Audit Preparation

For each audit:

1. Assign an audit team leader and auditors.
2. Define audit scope, criteria, and objectives.
3. Review previous audit reports and corrective actions.
4. Prepare audit checklists based on the applicable standards and procedures.
5. Notify the auditee at least 2 weeks before the audit date.
6. Provide the audit agenda to all participants.

Step 3: Audit Execution

Conduct the audit according to the following format:

Opening Meeting (15 minutes): - Introduce the audit team - Confirm the audit scope and agenda - Explain the audit methodology - Confirm logistics and contacts

Audit Activities (2-4 hours): - Interview process owners and operators - Review documented information - Observe process execution - Examine records and data - Take notes and collect objective evidence

Closing Meeting (30 minutes): - Present preliminary findings - Allow the auditee to clarify or dispute findings - Confirm the timeline for corrective actions

Step 4: Audit Report

Within 5 working days of the audit:

1. Prepare the audit report including:
 - Audit identification (date, scope, team)
 - Summary of findings
 - Non-conformances identified (referenced by NCR number)
 - Opportunities for improvement
 - Positive observations
2. Submit the report to the QA Manager for review.
3. Distribute the final report to process owners and management.

Step 5: Corrective Actions

For each non-conformance identified:

1. The auditee initiates an NCR per SOP-QA-012 within 5 working days.
2. If the finding is systemic, initiate a CAPA per CAPA-004.
3. Track corrective actions in the CAPA system.

Step 6: Follow-Up

The audit team leader verifies corrective actions within 60 days. If actions are not completed, escalate to the QA Manager.

Step 7: Management Review

Audit results are presented at the quarterly management review meeting.

Auditor Qualifications

Internal auditors must:

- Complete ISO 9001 internal auditor training

- Conduct at least 2 supervised audits before leading independently
- Complete refresher training every 3 years
- Be independent of the area they audit

Related Documents

- SOP-QA-012: Non-Conformance Report Procedure
- CAPA-004: Corrective and Preventive Action Procedure

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